SolarShare — UI/UX Brief

Version: 1.0 | **Companion to:** App Flow & User Journey document

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1. Design Principle

SolarShare's core UX challenge is **trust between strangers who share a wall, not a bank account.** Every design decision should reduce the perceived risk of "am I actually going to get paid / actually get my energy" — through clarity, not decoration. The interface should feel less like a trading app and more like a **shared utility meter for the whole society** — calm, legible, and honest about what's happening physically (grid supply) versus what's happening financially (the trade).

2. Design Token System

Color (carried over from the SolarShare system diagram, for brand consistency):

- `--bg` Deep navy `#0B1626` — night-sky base, calm and non-alarming for a utility product

- `--amber` `#FFB347` — solar/generation accent, used only for seller-side and "earning" moments
- `--teal` `#3ED9A8` — trade/verification accent, used for confirmed, ledger-backed actions
- `--grid-blue` `#6E8FC9` — reserved exclusively for grid/fallback states, so users learn to associate it with "standard supply, nothing to worry about"
- `--ink` `#EAF0FB` / `--muted` `#8CA0C2` — text hierarchy

Type:

- Display: **Space Grotesk** (technical, slightly geometric — reads as infrastructure, not consumer social app)
- Body: **Inter** (neutral, highly legible at small sizes for older/first-time smartphone users)
- Data/mono: **JetBrains Mono** for kWh figures, prices, and transaction hashes — numbers should visually read as "verified data," not as marketing copy

Layout concept: Card-based, single-column on mobile (this is a WhatsApp-adjacent, one-thumb product). No dense dashboards up front — one clear number, one clear action per screen.

Signature element: A live, small "grid pulse" — a subtle animated line showing energy currently

flowing into vs. out of the shared local pool, visible at the top of the Home screen. It's the one moment of motion in an otherwise calm interface, and it makes the otherwise-invisible concept of "shared grid" tangible.

3. Key Screens

3.1 Onboarding

- Single question at a time: "Do you have rooftop solar?" → branches to Prosumer or Buyer setup
- Verification step explained in plain language: *"We check your DISCOM account so trades are safe and count toward your real bill."* — not "KYC verification," which reads as bureaucratic friction
- WhatsApp option offered alongside app download from screen one, not buried in settings

3.2 Home / Dashboard (Prosumer)

- Top: today's generation vs. consumption, in plain kWh, with the "grid pulse" signature element
- One large card: current surplus available to sell, with a suggested price already filled in (editable)

- One button: **"List this surplus"** — active voice, states exactly what happens

3.3 Home / Dashboard (Buyer)

- Top: nearby available surplus right now (or "Running on standard grid" if none — stated plainly, not as an error)
- One card per nearby listing: seller (anonymized as "Unit B-204"), price, kWh available
- One button per listing: **"Buy at ₹X/unit"**

3.4 Trade Confirmation

- Shows both parties' agreed price, quantity, and a short transaction ID
- Copy: *"This trade is locked and recorded. It will appear in your next DISCOM bill."* — sets correct expectations that this isn't instant cash, it's a billing adjustment

3.5 Ledger / History

- Chronological list, most recent first
- Each entry: date, counterparty (anonymized), kWh, price, hash ID
- Empty state (new user): *"No trades yet. Once your solar makes more than you use, we'll suggest a price here."* — invitation to act, not a blank void

3.6 Society Admin Panel

- Society-wide totals: kWh traded, ₹ moved, CO_2 avoided
- Simple leaderboard (opt-in) of top contributing households — gamification kept light, never mandatory or shaming for low participation

4. Writing & Microcopy Guidance

- Name things by what the user controls: **"List surplus,"** not "Initiate export transaction."
- Never apologize in error states; state what happened and the next step: *"No buyers nearby right now — you're still earning the standard feed-in rate."*
- Keep the vocabulary identical across every touchpoint (app, WhatsApp bot, push notification) — if a button says "Buy," the confirmation message also says "bought," never "purchased" or "acquired."
- Numbers (kWh, ₹, %) are always shown in the monospace data face, so users learn to trust them as "real," distinct from marketing text.

5. Accessibility Requirements

- **WhatsApp-first parity:** every core action (list surplus, buy, check ledger) must be possible

through the WhatsApp bot, not just the native app — this is how the actual government pilot reaches first-time users, and SolarShare should match that bar.

- **Vernacular language support:** Hindi and at least one regional language (matching the pilot geography — e.g., a UP/Delhi-relevant language set) from MVP, not as a later localization pass.
- **Low-bandwidth tolerance:** screens must load meaningfully on 2G/3G fallback (common in the target smart-meter rollout areas); avoid heavy imagery, prefer text and simple iconography.
- **Voice input option** for the WhatsApp flow (e.g., "sell 2 units") for users less comfortable typing — a Phase 2 feature (see PRD Section 9 / Implementation Plan).

6. What This UI Deliberately Avoids

- No stock "fintech dashboard" look (dense charts, gradient cards, coin/wallet iconography) — this is a utility product, not a trading app, and should not visually imply speculation or volatility.
- No countdown timers or urgency mechanics on listings — creates anxiety in a product meant to feel as stable as electricity itself.

- No leaderboard pressure tactics — sustainability engagement should invite, not shame.